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Schuurbiers

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(54) **PHYSOCARPUS PLANT NAMED ‘GELESQ’**

(50) Latin Name: *Physocarpus opulifolius*
Varietal Denomination: **Gelesq**

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patent is extended or adjusted under 35
U.S.C. 154(b) by 157 days.

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A01H 5/00 (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.** **Plt./226**

(58) **Field of Classification Search** **Plt./226**
See application file for complete search history.

(56) **References Cited**

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

PP11,211 P * 2/2000 Kordes et al. Plt./226
PP14,821 P2 * 5/2004 Wood Plt./226

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new cultivar of *Physocarpus opulifolius*, ‘Gelesq’, charac-
terized by its dwarf, compact and broadly spreading plant
habit, its unique foliage with leaves that are dark gray to
purple-black in color, its ability to be readily propagated by
stem cuttings, and its hardiness to U.S.D.A. Zone 2.

1 Drawing Sheet

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Genus/species: *Physocarpus opulifolius*.
Varietal denomination: ‘Gelesq’.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct cultivar
of *Physocarpus opulifolius* and will be referred to hereafter
by its cultivar name, ‘Gelesq’. ‘Gelesq’ represents a new
cultivar of *Physocarpus*, a deciduous shrub grown for land-
scape use.

The new *Physocarpus* arose from a breeding program con-
ducted by the Inventor at his nursery in Eefde, The Nether-
lands. The objective of the breeding program was to develop
new *Physocarpus* cultivars with a compact growth habit mak-
ing them suitable for use as dwarf groundcovers.

The new *Physocarpus* originate from a controlled cross-
pollination made by the Inventor in a field in his nursery in
summer of 1995. The female parent was *Physocarpus opuli-
folius* ‘Monlo’ (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 11,211) and the male
parent was *Physocarpus opulifolius* ‘Dart’s Gold’ (Not pat-
ented). ‘Gelesq’ was selected as a single plant from a popu-
lation of progeny derived from the cross-pollination in Eefde,
The Netherlands in summer of 1997.

Asexual reproduction of the new cultivar was first accom-
plished by stem cuttings by the Inventor in the summer of
1998 in Eefde, The Netherlands. The characteristics of this
cultivar have been determined to be stable and are reproduced
true to type in successive generations.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

The following traits have been repeatedly observed and
represent the characteristics of the new *Physocarpus*. These
attributes in combination distinguish ‘Gelesq’ as unique and
distinct from all other cultivars of *Physocarpus* known to the
Inventor.

1. ‘Gelesq’ exhibits leaves that are a dark gray to purple-
black in color.

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2. The plant habit of ‘Gelesq’ is dwarf and compact with a
low, broadly spreading form.

3. ‘Gelesq’ is propagated readily from stem cutting and
forms well-developed fibrous root systems.

5 4. ‘Gelesq’ is hardy to U.S.D.A. Zone 2.

‘Gelesq’ was selected as unique for its dwarf, compact, and
low spreading growth habit as compared to the upright growth
habit that is typical of *Physocarpus* cultivars as well as for its
leaves that are dark grey to purple-black in color. ‘Monlo’, the
10 female parent, differs from ‘Gelesq’ in having foliage that is
lighter and more red-purple in color and in having a large,
upright growth habit. Dart’s Gold, the male parent, differs
from ‘Gelesq’ in having foliage that is yellow to gold in color,
and in also having has a large, upright growth habit.

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BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWING

The accompanying photographs were taken in September
of a three year-old plant of ‘Gelesq’ as grown outdoors in a
25-liter container under full sun in Eefde, The Netherlands
and are representative of the new *Physocarpus*.

The photograph in FIG. 1 provides a side view of a typical
plant of ‘Gelesq’.

25 The photograph in FIG. 2 provides a close-up view of a
single leaf of ‘Gelesq’.

The colors in the photograph may differ slightly from the
color values cited in the detailed botanical description, which
accurately describe the colors of the new cultivar.

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BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION OF THE PLANT

The following is a detailed description of a three year-old
plant of the new cultivar as grown outdoors in a 25-liter
container in Eefde, The Netherlands. Plants were grown
under average day temperatures of 14° to 32° C. and average
night temperatures of 5° to 15° C. Phenotypic differences
may be observed with variations in environmental, climatic,
and cultural conditions. The color determination is in accor-

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dance with The 2007 R.H.S. Colour Chart of The Royal Horticultural Society, London, England, except where general color terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used.
General description:

Plant type.—Deciduous shrub. 5

Plant and growth habit.—Dwarf, compact, broad-spreading.

Blooming period.—No flower observed to date.

Height and spread.—About 29 cm in height, about 69 cm in width. 10

Hardiness.—USDA Zone 2.

Diseases and pest resistance.—No particular susceptibility or resistance to diseases or pests has been observed.

Root description.—Fibrous, well-developed. 15

Growth and propagation:

Growth rate.—Slow to moderate.

Propagation.—Softwood stem cuttings.

Branch description:

Branch color.—New wood between N186C and 200A 20
with underside 187A, mature bark 200B.

Branch size.—Lateral branches are an average of 3.5 mm in diameter and an average of 18.5 cm in length.

Number of lateral branches.—An average of 28 per plant. 25

Branch surface.—Glabrous, dull, bark on old, mature branches peels from the surface.

Branch shape.—Round, slightly ribbed lengthways.

Branch internode length.—Average 1.9 cm.

Branch habit.—Freely branching, removal of terminal 30
tip (pinching) results in additional lateral branches.

Branch strength.—High.

Foliage description:

Leaf shape.—Ovate in outline, deeply tri-lobed, maple-like. 35

Leaf division.—Simple.

Leaf base.—Cordate.

Leaf apex.—Acute.

Leaf venation.—Palmate, color on upper surface between 147A and N186A, color on lower surface 147B and darkens to 187A to 187B near base of the leaf.

Leaf margin.—Tri-lobed, with secondary undulations, all edges are crenated, average of 3.5 teeth per cm.

Leaf attachment.—Petiolate.

Leaf arrangement.—Alternate.

Leaf surface.—Glabrous on upper and lower surfaces, very slightly rugose, glossy.

Leaf length.—Average of 8.1 cm.

Leaf width.—Average of 6.4 cm.

Leaf number.—About 7 per lateral branch.

Leaf color.—Young foliage; upper surface between N186A and 202A, lower surface near N187A, tinges of 189A, mature foliage; upper surface between N186 and 202A, lower surface 147B.

Petiole size.—About 2.1 cm in length, about 2 mm in width.

Petiole shape.—Sulcate.

Petiole color.—Upper surface between N186 and 202A, lower surface 187A to 187B.

Petiole texture.—Glabrous.

Flower description: No flowers observed in ten years of observation.

Fruit and seed.—None observed to date.

It is claimed:

1. A new and distinct cultivar of *Physocarpus* plant named ‘Gelesq’ substantially as herein illustrated and described.

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FIG. 1



FIG. 2